

BRAND IDENTITY & GUIDELINES

OBSIDIAN

CAPITAL PARTNERS

VERSION 1.0

MAY 2026

CONFIDENTIAL

OCP-BIG-2026

OI

Brand Foundation

The fixed core. Every decision downstream — visual, verbal, structural — is a consequence of what is defined here. Read it as constraint, not suggestion.

1.1

Brand Positioning Statement

One paragraph. No revision cycles. Carved.

Obsidian Capital Partners is the principal that stays. In a capital market defined by intermediaries who route transactions and depart, we take ownership positions in infrastructure and industrial platform companies — structuring capital, building management capacity, and compounding value across cycles measured in years, not quarters. We do not advise from a distance. We do not optimize for transaction volume. We select a small number of businesses where structural advantage is buildable, commit our capital and our time, and remain until the architecture we designed has been tested by the market. This is not a service offering. It is a building orientation — and the discipline to hold it.

1.2

Brand Architecture

Three tiers. One parent. Defined relationships, not improvised ones.

TIER 01 — MASTER BRAND

Obsidian Capital Partners

The institutional parent. All authority, all credibility, all accountability flows upward to this name. Never subordinated to a platform brand in any investor, public, or partner context. Controls palette, typography, structural design language.

TIER 02 — PLATFORM BRANDS

Endorsed Brands

Hydronex / HydroCore, Tempist Systems, and OpenLoop KSA operate as endorsed brands — they carry independent identities within a defined relationship to the Obsidian master brand. Each may develop sector-specific voice and visual accents, within the bounds of this document.

TIER 03 — SUB-BRANDS

Operational Marks

Product lines, service divisions, or joint-venture vehicles operating beneath a platform brand. These must be anchored by at least one tier-two endorsed brand name and may not reference Obsidian directly without tier-two intermediation.

SUB-BRAND RELATIONSHIP RULES

- All platform brand materials must carry an "An Obsidian Capital Partners Platform Company" lockup — no exceptions in investor-facing or public contexts.
- The Obsidian wordmark may not be smaller than the platform wordmark in any co-branded material.
- Platform brands may not issue press releases, fundraising materials, or partnership announcements without OCP brand sign-off.
- Color deviations for platform brands are permitted within defined sector accent rules (Section 3.4) — but the primary OCP palette governs all shared surfaces.
- No platform brand may describe itself as an advisory or consulting entity. All language must reflect the principal-ownership relationship to Obsidian.

1.3

Brand Personality

Five attributes. Each with a behavior — and an anti-attribute to kill the cliché version.

01

Forged

IN PRACTICE

Communication that carries mass. Visual identity that has permanence. Every element earns its presence — no decoration without function, no softening for comfort.

NOT THIS

Not Swiss-minimalism for aesthetics alone. Not "clean" as a style choice without substance behind it. Not polished to the point of being frictionless.

02

Precise

IN PRACTICE

Every number cited is defensible. Every word is chosen for specificity. No redundancy in language. No approximate language in financial contexts. Precision as a form of respect.

NOT THIS

Not clinical. Not bureaucratic formality. Precision does not mean cold — it means exact, which is a different thing entirely.

03

Long-Duration

IN PRACTICE

Communication references cycles, not quarters. Brand language compounds on itself — later materials reference earlier ones. Visual identity is designed to age with authority, not become stale.

NOT THIS

Not "patient" as a passive trait. Not slow. Not timid. Long-duration is an active, deliberate posture — not inertia dressed as philosophy.

04

Principal-Minded

IN PRACTICE

"We" language that reflects ownership orientation. Communication that assumes alignment of interest, not a client-service relationship. We speak as owners, not as advisors.

NOT THIS

Not adversarial. Not extractive. Principal-minded does not mean self-interested — it means that our interests are genuinely and structurally aligned with the companies we back.

05

Kinetic

IN PRACTICE

Verbs that imply building, movement, and accumulation. Visual system has direction and momentum — never static or declarative. The brand is in motion. Always building.

NOT THIS

Not frenetic. Not startup-urgent. Kinetic energy here is measured and directional — the force of compounding, not the noise of activity.

1.4

Brand Voice

Four registers. One identity. The voice does not change — the register shifts for context.

Institutional

Used in investor decks, LP communications, mandate letters, and capital structure proposals. Dense, authoritative, citation-grounded. Speaks to institutions as peers — no soft sell, no warm introductions, no throat-clearing. Numbers precede narrative. Structure precedes sentiment.

- PEER-TO-PEER
- NUMBER-FIRST
- NO HEDGING
- STRUCTURAL

REGISTER 02

Operational

Used in client engagements, internal frameworks, project delivery, and diligence documentation. Direct, framework-oriented, assumption-free. Clear directives. Respects the intelligence of the operators we work alongside. No jargon as performance. Every sentence does a job.

- DIRECTIVE
- FRAMEWORK-LED
- OPERATOR RESPECT
- NO FILLER

REGISTER 03

Public

Used on the website, in press, and in public announcements. Confident, controlled, and minimal. Every public-facing word is load-bearing. Headlines that could survive a billboard. No press-release language. No excited announcements. No superlatives of any kind.

- MINIMAL
- CONTROLLED
- NO SUPERLATIVES
- BILLBOARD TEST

REGISTER 04

Platform

Hydronex/HydroCore: Infrastructure pragmatism. Technical without being academic — speaks to engineers, operators, and municipal procurement. Tempist Systems: Industrial precision. Operator-to-operator directness, performance language, no abstraction. OpenLoop KSA: Healthcare gravity. Patient-outcomes orientation, not technology enthusiasm. Warm, but not light.

- SECTOR-GROUNDED
- OCP PARENT-CONSISTENT
- NO OVERLAP

VOICE IN PRACTICE — BEFORE & AFTER

BEFORE

"Obsidian Capital Partners is a leading M&A advisory firm focused on delivering value-creating transactions across multiple sectors to help our clients achieve their strategic goals."

AFTER

"Obsidian structures and executes capital transactions in infrastructure and industrial platforms. We take principal positions. We build companies. We stay."

BEFORE

"We are excited to announce our strategic partnership with Hydronex Water Solutions, which will help create powerful synergies across the water infrastructure space."

AFTER

"Obsidian Capital Partners has taken a principal position in Hydronex. Water infrastructure is a structurally constrained market with multi-decade demand visibility. We intend to compound within it."

BEFORE

"Our experienced team of seasoned professionals brings a proven track record of successful deal execution and value creation to every client engagement."

AFTER

"The Obsidian principals have structured over \$2B in industrial transactions. Our equity is in these businesses. So is our time."

1.5

Messaging Pillars

Three load-bearing claims. Every piece of communication can be traced back to one of these.

01

We Build. We Don't Broker.

The advisory-to-principal distinction is Obsidian's sharpest competitive edge. Most capital platforms optimize for transaction volume. We optimize for company quality. The difference is visible in structure, in tenure, and in how we show up when a business faces difficulty — which is the only test that matters.

PROOF POINT

Principal positions taken across all active platforms. Obsidian capital is deployed alongside — never above — operator capital.

HEADLINE EXAMPLE

02

Structure Is Strategy.

At the growth capital stage, how a company is structured determines what it can become. Obsidian architects ownership structures, governance frameworks, and incentive alignment before committing capital. The deal architecture is the strategy — not a consequence of it.

PROOF POINT

Every engagement begins with a structure review. Advisory retainers are tied to milestone-based deliverables — not to hours billed.

HEADLINE EXAMPLE

"We don't route capital. We commit it."

"The structure of a deal determines the quality of its future."

03

Patience Is the Business Model.

Capital markets reward liquidity. Obsidian deliberately accepts illiquidity in exchange for compounding time. The businesses we build in Year 1 are designed to be stronger in Year 7. This orientation changes what we acquire, how we operate, and what we consider success.

PROOF POINT

Principal capital vehicles structured at 7–10 year durations. No pressure for early exit. Management fee and carry aligned to long-duration outcomes.

HEADLINE EXAMPLE

"Patience is not a virtue here. It is the business model."

02

Visual Identity System

The formal language of the brand. Precise, referential, and non-negotiable in the elements marked immutable.

2.1

Logo Concept & Usage

A design brief for the mark — not a placeholder. Execute against this exactly.

LOGO SPECIMENS (TYPE-SET)



WORDMARK BRIEF

Structure & Rationale

The wordmark is set in Cormorant Garamond Light, tracked wide at +150/1000em. "OBSIDIAN" occupies the dominant line, scaled 2.5× the height of the subsidiary line. "CAPITAL PARTNERS" sits below in Montserrat Regular, tracked at +400/1000em, full caps. The serif-to-sans pairing within the lockup is intentional: editorial authority above, structural precision below. The scale contrast creates hierarchy without requiring any supporting graphic element. No tagline is used within the wordmark.

SYMBOL BRIEF

The Obsidian Mark

The symbol draws from the physical properties of volcanic obsidian glass: conchoidal fracture — the clean, curved break pattern unique to amorphous materials. The mark is a precision-drawn irregular heptagon, with one internal fracture line bisecting the form at a 23° angle from vertical, referencing obsidian's natural cleavage planes. The polygon is not symmetrical. It is not a gemstone. It is a geological event — precise because the material demands it, not because a designer imposed it. Rendered in solid black only (no gradients, no outlines, no 3D treatment). Works at 16px and at 4-meter scale.

CLEAR SPACE

Minimum Isolation Zone

The minimum clear space on all four sides of the wordmark equals the cap-height of the "O" in OBSIDIAN. For the symbol mark in isolation, clear space equals the full height of the mark on all sides. This zone may not be broken by any element — text, imagery, border, or color edge — in any approved usage context.

MINIMUM SIZE

Legibility Floor

Digital: Wordmark not smaller than 120px wide. Symbol not smaller than 20px. Print: Wordmark not smaller than 32mm wide. Symbol not smaller than 8mm. Below these thresholds, use text-only identification ("Obsidian Capital Partners" in Montserrat Medium). The mark is never scaled to a size where its detail is lost.

FORBIDDEN USES

01	Never use gold or yellow as a wordmark color on a white or light background — insufficient contrast and reads as decorative.	02	Never stretch, compress, or alter the aspect ratio of the wordmark or symbol in any dimension.
03	Never place the wordmark over a busy photographic background without a clear field or scrim.	04	Never apply drop shadows, glows, gradients, or any effect to the wordmark or symbol mark.
05	Never use the symbol in isolation without the wordmark in any first-use investor or public context.	06	Never recreate the wordmark in any typeface other than Cormorant Garamond — including "close" alternatives.
07	Never rotate the wordmark or symbol. The mark is always horizontal, always upright.	08	Never use an outlined or stroked version of the wordmark. Solid only.
09	Never place the wordmark in a box, circle, or any containing shape that is not part of an approved lockup.	10	Never use mid-gray (#6B6B6B) as the wordmark color. Approved colors are Parchment, Obsidian Black, and Gold only.

2.2

Color System

Six named colors. Two new extensions. One functional tier. Eight approved pairings.

PRIMARY PALETTE



Obsidian Black #0A0A0A All primary backgrounds. The dominant surface. Never used as text color on dark backgrounds.	Parchment #F5F2EE Primary text on dark backgrounds. Light-mode surface. Never use as background in digital primary contexts.

ACCENT PALETTE

Gold #B8965A Primary accent. CTAs, active nav states, section eyebrows, decorative rules. Never as a full background.	Gold Light #D4AF78 Hover states, pull quote text, secondary subheadings. Softer moments where full Gold reads too heavy.	Forge Steel #1C2535 Secondary background surfaces. Data-heavy layouts, tech/infrastructure contexts. Provides depth beyond pure black.	Ember #C4883A Kinetic accent moments. Industrial/physical contexts. Warm gradient stops. Distinct from Gold — more orange, more physical energy.

NEUTRAL & STRUCTURAL PALETTE

Rule Dark #2A2A2A Divider lines, card borders, nav borders, structural separators. The skeleton of the layout.	Mid Gray #6B6B6B Secondary body copy, captions, labels, supporting text. Never for headlines or primary body in any context.

FUNCTIONAL PALETTE — STATUS COLORS

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Structural Green #2D5C3D Success states. Deep forest — institutional, not celebratory. Used in status indicators, pipeline stages, completion marks.	Structural Amber #7A5A1E Warning/pending states. Deep amber-gold — on-brand with the palette. Not alarming; requiring attention.	Structural Burgundy #5C2D2D Error/critical states. Deep burgundy — institutional gravity, not alarming red. Used in risk flags, blocking conditions.
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APPROVED COLOR PAIRINGS

Aa BLACK / PARCHMENT Primary — all body text on dark backgrounds	Aa BLACK / GOLD Hero, CTA, editorial accent moments	Aa BLACK / GOLD LIGHT Secondary accents, subheadings, hover states
Aa PARCHMENT / BLACK Light-mode documents, letterhead, print	Aa FORGE STEEL / PARCHMENT Data panels, secondary slides, tech contexts	Aa FORGE STEEL / GOLD Data panels with accented headers or labels
Aa BLACK / MID GRAY Supporting text hierarchy, captions, metadata	— RULE DARK / GOLD Divider lines with adjacent gold accent — nav, section rules	

2.3

Typography System

Two primary typefaces. One tertiary. One type scale. Zero improvisation.

Primary Serif — Cormorant Garamond. Editorial authority. Used for all display, H1, H2, pull quotes, and positioning copy. Weight range: 300 (Light) through 600 (SemiBold). Italic used for pull quotes and lede text only.

Primary Sans — Montserrat. Structural precision. Used for all navigational, operational, body, label, and data text. Weight range: 300 (Light) through 700 (Bold). Never italic — direction, not decoration.

Tertiary Mono — Space Mono. Introduced for data tables, financial figures, technical documentation, and code-adjacent contexts. The monospace grid implies numerical precision and machine reliability — appropriate for Hydronex and Tempist platform contexts.

DISPLAY / HERO Cormorant Garamond 300 Light · 80-104px tracking -0.02em · lh 1.0	We Build.
HEADING 1 Cormorant Garamond 400 Regular · 56px tracking -0.01em · lh 1.1	Capital Architecture
HEADING 2 Cormorant Garamond 400 Regular · 40px tracking 0 · lh 1.2	Platform Companies
HEADING 3 Montserrat 600 SemiBold · 20px tracking 0.05em · uppercase · lh 1.3	INVESTMENT MANDATE
HEADING 4 Montserrat 500 Medium · 16px tracking 0.07em · lh 1.4	Transaction Overview
BODY LARGE Montserrat 300 Light · 18px tracking 0 · lh 1.8	We select, shape, and compound.

BODY

Montserrat
300 Light · 15px
tracking 0.02em · lh 1.75

Obsidian deploys principal capital in infrastructure and industrial platform companies with long-duration orientation.

BODY SMALL

Montserrat
400 Regular · 13px
tracking 0.01em · lh 1.6

Advisory retainer: \$20,000–\$50,000 per month. Transaction success fee: 1–4%.

CAPTION

Montserrat
400 Regular · 11px
tracking 0.08em · uppercase ·
lh 1.5

SOURCE: OBSIDIAN CAPITAL PARTNERS INTERNAL ANALYSIS, Q1 2026

LABEL

Montserrat
600 SemiBold · 10px
tracking 0.15em · uppercase

TRANSACTION STATUS

EYEBROW

Montserrat
700 Bold · 10px
tracking 0.32em · uppercase ·
Gold

PLATFORM COMPANIES

NUMERIC / DATA

Space Mono
400 Regular · 14px
tracking 0 · lh 1.5 · Gold
Light

\$248,500,000 · 4.00% · 10% carry · 7-yr duration

PULL QUOTE

Cormorant Garamond
400 Italic · 28px
tracking 0.01em · Gold · lh
1.45

"We don't route capital. We commit it."

SERIF LEADS

- Hero and editorial moments requiring authority
- Positioning and brand copy (headlines, taglines)
- Pull quotes and lede paragraphs
- Document titles and investment deck covers
- Any context where permanence is the intent

SANS LEADS

- Navigation, labels, eyebrows, and all UI text
- Body copy in operational documents
- Data annotations and financial tables
- Legal footnotes, disclaimers, and metadata
- All Heading 3 and H4 hierarchy

NEVER PERMITTED

- ✗ Cormorant Garamond at below 13px in any context
- ✗ Montserrat Italic — the sans is never italicized
- ✗ Bold Cormorant Garamond (700) for body copy
- ✗ Gold color for primary body paragraphs
- ✗ More than two typefaces in a single layout
- ✗ System fonts as fallback in brand materials

2.4

Iconography & Mark System

Stroke-based. Square-capped. No rounding. The icon language matches the brand: angular, precise, no softening.

ICON DESIGN LANGUAGE

Specification

All icons are stroke-based at 1.5px stroke weight. Fill is used only for specific filled accent icons (e.g., active states). Corner radius: 0 — obsidian fractures at sharp angles, not curves. Stroke cap: square. Join: miter. Icon grid: 24×24px with 2px optical padding. Scaling: always in 8px increments (16, 24, 32, 48px). Color: Parchment on dark surfaces, Obsidian Black on light. Gold used only for active/highlighted states.

ICON CATEGORIES

Four Sets

Navigation: Arrow right, arrow down, menu, close, external link, back, forward.

Transaction: Deal stage markers, capital flow indicators, ownership pyramid, cycle arrows.

Platform: Water drop (Hydronex), circuit/automation mark (Tempist), health cross (OpenLoop).

Data/Metrics: Line chart, percentage indicator, yield arrow, clock face (duration), document mark, filter.

ICON SPECIMENS (SVG)

 ARROW RIGHT	 ARROW DOWN	 MENU	 CLOSE	 EXTERNAL	 CHART	 DURATION	 HYDRONEX
 TEMPIST	 OPENLOOP	 DATA	 DOCUMENT				

MARK SYSTEM — GRAPHIC DEVICES

 DIAMOND MARK SECTION BULLET	 EM RULE LIST MARKER	 VERTICAL BAR SEPARATOR	 GOLD RULE 40PX SECTION DIVIDER	 FULL RULE CONTENT SEPARATOR
 NUMERIC ORDERED LIST				

2.5

Photography & Visual Direction

Photography is not decoration. It is evidence of the physical world our capital operates in.

OI

O2

Infrastructure Industrial facilities, pipeline systems, water treatment plants, data center interiors, manufacturing floors. Dramatic single-source lighting with hard shadows — the physical substance of capital deployed. No wide-angle distortion. No HDR treatment. The frame should feel honest, not cinematic-for-its-own-sake.	People Principals and operators in working environments — not posed portraits. Shot candidly in motion: reviewing data, in conversation, walking plant floors. Direct camera contact only in formal headshot contexts. No conference-room smiles. No diversity-performance casting. People who are visibly doing actual work.
03 Abstraction Close-up material textures: raw obsidian stone, machined metal surfaces, aged paper, moving water, concrete. Macro or near-macro. No human presence. These images serve as section backgrounds and brand texture moments — they communicate material permanence, not concept.	

LIGHTING	Single-source industrial or natural light. High contrast ratio — shadows are as important as highlights. No fill cards that eliminate shadow. Gold tones lifted in metal surfaces and warm light. Blue-black shadow tones in deep areas. The image should feel like it was lit by the environment, not a studio.
COLOR GRADE	Desaturated mid-tones with warm blacks (slight amber lift in shadow). Highlights pulled toward warm parchment-white. Skin tones desaturated 20–30%. Gold and amber tones in metal, water, and warm light lifted 15%. No Instagram filters. No vignette. No color grading that calls attention to itself. The treatment should feel like memory — real but slightly distilled.
ASPECT RATIOS	Hero/full-bleed: 16:9 or 21:9. Section backgrounds: 3:1 cropped to center-weight. Portrait (people): 4:5 or 1:1 for headshots. Detail/texture: 1:1 or 4:3. Never crop below minimum recommended sizes — pixelation in brand contexts is a quality failure.
AVOID	Smiling executives in glass conference rooms. Generic city skylines. Stock handshakes and contract signings. False candid (staged "working" shots). Any image with visible brand logos of other companies unless cleared. Diversity performance casting. Action shots that imply urgency or stress. Anything that reads like a Big Four consulting brochure.

Motion & Animation Principles

Obsidian moves with purpose. Every animation is a consequence of something — never decoration.

EASING PHILOSOPHY

All motion uses smooth deceleration. Elements arrive at their destination crisply, without bounce or overshoot. The curve references the physical behavior of dense material — it accelerates quickly and decelerates with weight.

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cubic-bezier(0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94)
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TIMING STANDARDS

UI micro-interactions (hover, click)	150ms
Standard element transitions	300ms
Section and page reveals	500ms
Cover / cinematic brand moments	800–1200ms
Staggered list/grid reveals	60ms offset per item

TRANSITION STYLE

Elements enter via fade + translate (Y: 8–14px up). Never slide in from the side. Never scale in. The direction is always upward — emerging from depth, not arriving from outside the frame. Exit is fade-only.

MOTION NEVER

- ✗ Infinite rotation, spinning, or orbiting elements
- ✗ Bounce, spring, or elastic easing of any kind
- ✗ Parallax scrolling effects on background images
- ✗ Pulsing, throbbing, or heartbeat animations
- ✗ Particle effects, generative noise, or ambient motion
- ✗ Transitions faster than 100ms (unperceived = no communication value)

03

Brand Applications

How the identity performs in the real world — digital, document, physical, and across the platform portfolio.

3.1

Digital — Website

The website is not a brochure. It is the institutional record. Every design decision reflects that.

GRID SYSTEM

12-Column Layout

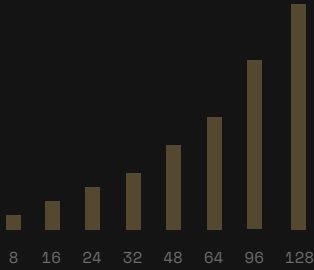
12-column grid. Outer margins: 80px at 1440px desktop, 48px at 1024px, 24px at 375px mobile. Column gutter: 24px fixed. Content max-width: 1280px centered. Primary content column: 8/12. Sidebar/supporting content: 4/12. Data tables span full 12 columns. Typography column (prose): 7/12 max-width (~700px) — never allow body copy to run full-width.

SPACING SYSTEM

8px Base Unit

All spacing values are multiples of 8px. Scale: 8, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96, 128, 192. Section padding: 96px vertical at desktop, 64px at tablet, 48px at mobile. Component internal padding: 24–48px depending on card weight. Never use non-8-multiple values in layout spacing. Margins and gutters are structural, not visual judgment calls.

SPACING SCALE VISUAL



COMPONENT DESIGN LANGUAGE

BUTTONS — PRIMARY & SECONDARY

REQUEST MANDATE

VIEW PORTFOLIO

LEARN MORE

DOWNLOAD BRIEF

Primary: 1px gold border, gold text, black bg → on hover: gold bg, black text. Secondary: 1px rule border, parchment text → on hover: parchment border. Focus state: 1px gold outline at 2px offset. Active: Gold deepens to #9A7A45.

CARD COMPONENT — STANDARD

PLATFORM COMPANY

Hydronex / HydroCore

Water infrastructure and treatment systems. Principal position held since Q3 2024. Structured capital vehicle: 7-year duration, 4% management fee.

Cards: 1px #2A2A2A border, #1A1A1A background, 0 border-radius, 28px internal padding. Hover: border-color transitions to rgba(184,150,90,.4) at 300ms. No drop shadows. No rounded corners.

HOVER STATES	Color transition to Gold at 150ms. No transform or scale on hover — no "lift" effect. Text and border color change only. Cursor: pointer on all interactive elements.
FOCUS STATES	1px solid Gold (#B8965A) outline, 2px offset. No browser-default blue rings. Applied to all keyboard-interactive elements. Never removed without replacement — accessibility is non-negotiable.
ACTIVE STATES	Gold deepens to #9A7A45. Background darkens one surface tier. Transition: 100ms — immediate tactile response.

NAVIGATION

Fixed position. Background: #0A0A0A at 96% opacity with backdrop-filter: blur(12px) on scroll. Border-bottom: 1px solid #2A2A2A. Active section: Gold text, no underline. Nav items: Montserrat 400, 13px, letter-spacing 0.06em.

3.2

Document System

Documents are the institutional record. They should read as primary sources, not design exercises.

INVESTMENT DECK

Template Structure

Cover: Full-bleed Obsidian Black, wordmark centered in Gold, document title in Cormorant Light below, date in Montserrat caption.

Section Break: Full-bleed with large section number (40% opacity Gold), section title in Cormorant 400, no other content.

Content Slides: Two-column 7/5 split — primary narrative left, supporting data right. Forge Steel sidebar for data panels.

Data Slides: Full Forge Steel background, Space Mono for all figures, Gold rules between categories.

Closing: Mirror of cover — wordmark, contact, OCP mark bottom-right.

EXECUTIVE MEMO

Format

A4 or US Letter. Background: Parchment (#F5F2EE). Text: Obsidian Black. OCP wordmark top-left in black, 32mm wide. Gold ruling line beneath header — 1px, full bleed. Body: Montserrat 300, 11pt, 1.7 line-height. Section headers: Montserrat 600, 9pt, tracked, uppercase, Gold color. Footer: 1px rule, OCP contact, document classification, page number in Space Mono.

TERM SHEET / MANDATE COVER

Cover Page Specification

Obsidian Black full-page background. OCP wordmark in Parchment, top-left, large. Document title in Cormorant Garamond 300 Italic, centered, 36pt. Parties: Montserrat 300, 12pt, below title. Date: Montserrat caption, Gold color, bottom-right. Single gold rule separating header from body. "Strictly Confidential" watermark: Montserrat 700, 11pt, tracking 0.3em, rotated 45°, 4% opacity, Parchment. Internal pages revert to executive memo format on Parchment stock.

Environmental & Physical

Physical materials are the brand at its most permanent. Production quality is non-negotiable.

BUSINESS CARD SYSTEM



Specification: 600gsm cotton-fiber stock, matte black with soft-touch coating front. No gloss. Gold foil on wordmark (front side only). Back printed in Parchment (#F5F2EE) at 85% opacity for warmth. Single gold ruling line 12mm from bottom edge. Dimensions: 85mm × 54mm standard. Name in Cormorant Garamond 400, 13pt. All other text Montserrat.

LETTERHEAD	A4/US Letter. 120gsm Parchment-tinted laid stock. OCP wordmark top-left, 34mm, in Obsidian Black. Gold rule line (1pt) full-width below header zone. 25mm top margin, 20mm side margins. Footer: gold rule, OCP legal entity name, jurisdiction, page number in Space Mono 9pt.
PRESENTATION FOLDER	A4 portrait. Matte black 400gsm board with soft-touch laminate. OCP monogram ("OC") debossed lower-right front cover — no print, structural embossing only. Spine: "OBSIDIAN CAPITAL PARTNERS" in Montserrat 400 running vertically, 8pt, gold foil. Two interior pockets with curved-cut right pocket.
SIGNAGE / ENVIRONMENTAL	Primary office signage: Dimensional letters in brushed blackened steel, 80–120mm cap height. Mounted directly to wall without backing plate. Lobby/reception: Wordmark at 400mm wide, Gold-finish powder coat on steel. Directional signage: Montserrat Medium, laser-cut acrylic in Obsidian Black. No vinyl decal signage for primary environments — physical permanence is the requirement.
EVENT / CONFERENCE	Backdrop: Full-bleed Obsidian Black fabric. Centered wordmark at 600mm wide in Parchment. No repeating logo pattern — single wordmark, centered. Podium: Matte black with OCP mark, 80mm, in Gold foil. Collateral table: Matte black tablecloth, no signage beyond a single tent card in brand type.

Platform Brand Extensions

Each platform carries the Obsidian lineage while earning the right to its own identity within defined bounds.

AN OBSIDIAN CAPITAL PARTNERS PLATFORM COMPANY

Hydronex

WATER INFRASTRUCTURE

Hydronex operates in water treatment and distribution infrastructure — a capital-intensive, regulation-dense, multi-decade-duration market. The brand personality is pragmatic and technically credible. It speaks to municipal procurement officers, infrastructure engineers, and federal program managers. It borrows the structural precision of the OCP parent brand and adds a single sector accent color (Steel Blue #3D7A96) used only for technical diagrams and system graphics — never as a primary surface. The HydroCore sub-brand, used for the core technology platform, follows identical rules but with a narrower sans-only typographic approach for all technical documentation.

- OCP lockup required on all investor, public, and partner materials
- Cormorant Garamond for Hydronex headlines; Montserrat for operational content
- Steel Blue accent only in technical/diagram contexts — never as background
- HydroCore sub-brand: sans-only type, Space Mono for technical specifications

AN OBSIDIAN CAPITAL PARTNERS PLATFORM COMPANY

Tempist Systems

INDUSTRIAL AUTOMATION

Tempist Systems operates in industrial automation and control systems — a precision-manufacturing, operator-first environment. The brand voice is operator-to-operator: no abstraction, no technology hype, technical authority without academic distance. The visual identity inherits OCP's structure but introduces a Forge Amber accent (#8A5E28) for industrial-specific contexts — safety markers, process diagrams, equipment callouts. Typography skews heavier than the OCP parent: Montserrat 500 (Medium) replaces Light as the body weight in all Tempist operational documentation. Physical materials use matte industrial finishes rather than soft-touch.

- OCP lockup required on all materials except on-machine labeling
- Montserrat Medium (500) as body weight — not Light — in technical docs
- Forge Amber accent only for industrial/safety diagram contexts
- Space Mono for all specifications, part numbers, and technical data

AN OBSIDIAN CAPITAL PARTNERS PLATFORM COMPANY

OpenLoop KSA

HEALTHCARE · DIGITAL HEALTH · KSA

OpenLoop KSA operates in Saudi Arabia's digital health and healthcare infrastructure sector under Vision 2030 frameworks. Of the three platform brands, OpenLoop requires the most contextual adaptation — Arabic typography must be treated as a primary typeface, not a translation afterthought. The brand inherits OCP structure and pairs it with a Healthcare

Teal accent (#3D7A68) for clinical and care-pathway contexts. Voice is warmer and more accessible than the OCP parent without becoming light: patient outcomes language, not technology enthusiasm. KSA-specific materials follow NHC and SDAIA compliance guidelines for health data references and must be reviewed by regional counsel before publication.

- OCP lockup required; Arabic version of lockup required for KSA materials
- Arabic typeface: IBM Plex Arabic — structured, pairs with Montserrat register
- Healthcare Teal accent for clinical diagrams and patient-pathway contexts
- All KSA public materials reviewed by regional legal before publication

O4

Brand Governance

Who decides. What changes. What does not. The system that keeps the brand honest over time.

4.1

Brand Stewardship

Accountability is structural, not aspirational. Decisions have owners.

BRAND OWNERSHIP

Decision Rights

The Managing Principal of Obsidian Capital Partners holds ultimate brand authority. Day-to-day stewardship is delegated to the designated Brand Lead (Head of Communications or equivalent). Platform brand decisions are managed at the platform level within the bounds of this document — but any deviation from OCP master brand rules requires Managing Principal review. No external agency, partner, or portfolio company may make unilateral changes to any element defined in this document.

BRAND AUTHORITY

What This Document Is

This document is the authoritative source. It supersedes any prior brand guidelines, slide templates, email signatures, or design files in circulation. Version 1.0 is effective immediately upon distribution. Questions of interpretation are resolved by the Brand Lead; questions of exception require Managing Principal approval. Undocumented use cases default to the spirit of this document — when in doubt, do less.

BRAND APPROVAL MATRIX

ACTION	SELF-CERTIFY	BRAND LEAD	MANAGING PRINCIPAL
Internal presentations using approved templates	✓	—	—
Marketing collateral within defined brand system	—	✓	—
New platform brand visual identity	—	◆	✓
Co-brand / partner lockup creation	—	—	✓
Investor-facing or LP materials	—	◆	✓
Press releases and public announcements	—	—	✓
Exception to any rule in this document	—	—	✓
Major brand evolution or system refresh	—	—	✓

◆ = Brand Lead reviews and recommends; Managing Principal retains final approval authority

4.2

What Good Looks Like

Five examples of on-brand execution. Five that are never acceptable. Memorize both lists.

ON BRAND — EXECUTE LIKE THIS

- ✓ A one-page investment mandate: no decorative elements, two typefaces, precise financial metrics in Space Mono, a clear structural summary, and a single gold ruling line. Reads in under two minutes. Answers every structural question without being asked.
- ✓ A website hero section: obsidian stone photography in full bleed at high contrast, a single tagline in Cormorant Garamond Light ("We build companies. We architect capital."), one CTA button, and nothing else. No subheads, no bullet points, no paragraphs.
- ✓ Business cards with exactly five pieces of information: name, title, email, phone, website. No social handles. No QR code. No physical address. Matte black, gold foil wordmark. The restraint is the message.
- ✓ A platform brand deck that opens on slide one with the OCP parent relationship lockup ("A platform company of Obsidian Capital Partners") before any platform content appears. The lineage is stated before the offering.
- ✓ A press release written in three paragraphs. No boilerplate about "leading" or "committed to excellence." No quotes from executives expressing excitement. The announcement contains only verifiable facts and a contact line. It reads like a primary source.

OFF BRAND — NEVER EXECUTE LIKE THIS

- ✗ An investment deck with 40+ slides, gradient backgrounds, stock photography of confident executives, and a "Our Journey" timeline slide. The slide count alone signals that the presenter does not trust the content.
- ✗ The Gold color (#B8965A) used as a full background on any slide, card, or section. Gold is an accent. The moment it becomes a background it reads as a luxury brand, not an institutional one.
- ✗ Cormorant Garamond used at 10px or below for body copy in data-dense documents. Below 13px the typeface loses the quality that earns its place in the system — it becomes illegible ornamentation.
- ✗ A platform brand press release, website, or deck that makes no reference to Obsidian Capital Partners. Platform brands do not exist independently in the public record. The parent relationship is structural, not optional.
- ✗ Website or pitch copy that uses "leverage," "synergies," "best-in-class," "world-class," "ecosystem," "disruptive," or "passionate." Each of these words is evidence that the writer did not trust the actual facts to carry the communication. Cut them.

4.3

Co-Brand & Partnership Rules

Obsidian does not subordinate itself to any partner brand. The relationship is always stated, never implied.

OCP and Capital Partners

- OCP wordmark appears at equal or greater size than any co-appearing institution
- OCP always uses its own palette — never adopts partner color or typeface
- Separation: minimum 2× OCP clear space between marks
- Placement: OCP appears left or above partner brand in any dual-brand layout
- Never combine marks — both must retain full individual integrity
- LP logos appear in grayscale in OCP materials unless co-brand agreement specifies otherwise

OCP and Platform Companies

- Standard lockup: OCP wordmark at top, platform name below, separated by a 1px gold rule
- Platform brand color accents are permitted only below the gold rule separator
- Platform names may not appear larger than OCP wordmark in any combined lockup
- Minimum brand presence: "An Obsidian Capital Partners Platform Company" in Montserrat caption on every platform-brand page footer and investor deck cover
- OCP may not be abbreviated (not "OCP") in any platform brand context — full name required

The Floor

In every context where Obsidian appears alongside another brand — whether as parent, partner, or sponsor — the OCP wordmark must be present at minimum 60% of the height of the dominant brand mark in the composition. The wordmark may never be represented only by an abbreviation or monogram in investor-facing or public contexts. In digital contexts, at least one full reference to "Obsidian Capital Partners" must appear in the visible viewport without scrolling.

The brand is designed to last. Evolution is earned, not scheduled. Some things do not change.

TRIGGERS FOR BRAND REVIEW

- Geographic expansion into a new primary market (beyond US and KSA)
- Entry into an asset class that materially differs from current platform mandate
- Major acquisition that creates a naming conflict with existing platform brands
- Five-year scheduled review from version date (May 2031)
- A reputational event requiring strategic repositioning
- Merger, joint venture, or co-GP structure that changes the principal identity

IMMUTABLE — NEVER CHANGES

- Primary color pair: Obsidian Black (#0A0A0A) and Gold (#B8965A)
- Typographic pair: Cormorant Garamond + Montserrat
- Core positioning: principal-minded, company-building, long-duration
- The three messaging pillars in substance (if not exact wording)
- The five brand personality attributes

FLEXIBLE — MAY ADAPT

- Platform brand visual identities (within OCP structural bounds)
- Photography style and color grade as medium evolves
- Individual copy and messaging for specific market contexts
- Digital component patterns and interaction design
- Accent color extensions (Forge Steel, Ember) — may be updated at review
- Platform-specific typeface additions (e.g., Arabic for KSA expansion)